Urban Space Ethogram Activity, 7 October 2021

***Name:*____________________________**

How much difference can a small green space make in a city? Campus Pond is a perfect example of how a small natural feature in a relatively urban area can make a large difference for the animals around it.

Flanking the pond is a variety of greenery, including native trees, wetland rushes, and wildflowers. Notice the medley of insects that visit these plants. You will see bumblebees (*Bombus impatiens*) and honeybees (*Apis mellifera*) foraging for flowers around the pond. Cicadas can be heard in the foliage, and a large diversity of other insects can easily be found in the brush. A lone blue heron (*Ardea herodias*) can often be seen stalking the shallows of the pond, while mallard ducks (*Anas platyrhynchos*) float lazily in the water. Standing on the Isle of View, one can see a variety of freshwater fish in the water.

Our focus today are the Canada geese (*Branta canadensis*) that can often be found in the pond for most of the year. This time of year is an excellent opportunity to observe these charismatic animals, as hordes of them visit the pond as they fly southward. Please refer to the following chart to recognize some of their common behaviors:

Behavior	**Description**	**Code**
Ambulatory	Walking on land, otherwise doing nothing else.	A
Floating	Floating in the water, moving in a direction	F
Roosting	Staying still in water or on land	R
Communication	Making a loud “honking” noise to other geese or people	H
Feeding	Eating grass or foliage by grabbing vegetation with beak	FE
Begging	Approaching humans for food (learned behavior)	B
Sentry	Staying still, staring in one direction	S
Flight	Taking off from the water in a group	FL
Aggression	Chasing after another goose or human	AG

Of course, there are many more not described here. You might also be interested in watching another animal. Feel free to describe your own behaviors in this chart below. Create a **name** for the behavior, write a brief **description**, and assign a one- or two-letter **code**.

Behavior	**Description**	**Code**

ACTIVITY

Your task today is to create an ethogram for at least three animals. Have a timer ready with you. Observe an animal for 5 minutes. Every 15 seconds, list down what behavior the animal is doing (using a code!). Follow this example:

EXAMPLE:

Animal Observed:__Canada goose___ Location:__Pond near ILC_ Time Start:_5:21 PM

Time	Behaviour	Time	Behaviour	Time	Behaviour	Time	Behaviour
15 s	F	1:30	R	2:45	S	4:00	F
30	R	1:45	R	3:00	B	4:15	FL
45	F	2:00	C	3:15	AG	4:30	Stop (left)
1:00	FE	2:15	A	3:30	A	4:45	
1:15	F	2:30	A	3:45	F	5:00	

OBSERVATIONS:

Animal observed:______________________ Location:_____________________ Time start:___________

Time	Behaviour	Time	Behaviour	Time	Behaviour	Time	Behaviour
15 s		1:30		2:45		4:00	
30		1:45		3:00		4:15	
45		2:00		3:15		4:30	
1:00		2:15		3:30		4:45	
1:15		2:30		3:45		5:00	

Animal observed:______________________ Location:_____________________ Time start:___________

Time	Behaviour	Time	Behaviour	Time	Behaviour	Time	Behaviour
15 s		1:30		2:45		4:00	
30		1:45		3:00		4:15	
45		2:00		3:15		4:30	
1:00		2:15		3:30		4:45	
1:15		2:30		3:45		5:00	

Animal observed:______________________ Location:_____________________ Time start:___________

Time	Behaviour	Time	Behaviour	Time	Behaviour	Time	Behaviour
15 s		1:30		2:45		4:00	
30		1:45		3:00		4:15	
45		2:00		3:15		4:30	
1:00		2:15		3:30		4:45	
1:15		2:30		3:45		5:00	